

KALE REALTY

\$275 MILLION LOST TO FRAUD LAST YEAR.

The FBI's own numbers, and the one habit that catches most of it before the wire goes out.

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**COMPLAINTS ARE
UP 30 PERCENT.
THE MONEY LOST
IS UP 90 PERCENT.**

FBI data on real estate fraud, 2023 to 2025. The average loss per case is climbing, not just the count.

THE SCAMS AREN'T GETTING MORE COMMON. THEY'RE GETTING MORE EXPENSIVE.

The FBI's Internet Crime Complaint Center logged 9,521 real estate fraud complaints in 2023, totaling about \$145 million. By 2025 that was 12,368 complaints and \$275 million. Complaints rose 30 percent. The money lost rose 90 percent. The average loss per complaint climbed from about \$15,000 to about \$22,000, a 46 percent jump. Whoever is running these scams isn't casting a wider net. They're walking away with more per deal.

BEFORE THE NEXT WIRE GOES OUT, CHECK:

- 1** **Call the title company at a number you looked up yourself.**
Never the number on the email
- 2** **with the new instructions.**
- 3** **Treat any sudden change to wire instructions as a stop sign.**
Verify it by phone before you
- 4** **move a dollar.**
- 5** **Look at the sender's email domain, not just the name on it.**
One swapped letter is the
- 6** **whole scam.**
- 7** **Ask anyone who refuses a phone or video call why.**
NAR's own fraud hub flags that refusal
- 8** **as a top warning sign.**

THE TAKEAWAY

**A HUB DOESN'T
STOP A WIRE
FRAUD. A PHONE
CALL DOES.**

Pick up the phone before you ever move someone else's money.